

What's New About Storage Technologies?

How are storage systems and technologies evolving? How should your strategy change to adapt to the new tech? The answers to these and some other vital questions in the storage domain were explored by global leaders at a recent event. Here are a few excerpts...



Image Source: Designed by stories / Freepik

Organisations are now dealing with massive data that needs accessible, flexible and secured storage. So they need to build on storage systems and their standards, and this is where open source storage comes in.

Storage technologies and trends

There are five storage technologies in use today — file, block, object, persistent memory and addressable types of storage, and computational storage. An ideal storage solution supports

analytics and allows organisations to gather intelligence from the data in their virtual storage units.

A recent survey on 'Adoption of cloud storage infrastructure services' indicates a 20 per cent increase in cloud usage over just two years. Speaking during a panel discussion at the SODACON 2021 virtual event, Richelle Ahlvers, storage technology enablement architect, Intel, said: "There is more adoption of public cloud storage today, particularly for file share storage type applications."

Transition to SSDs: Solid-state drives (SSDs) have seen shifts in technology, and have moved from serial advanced technology attachment (SATA) to serial-attached SCSI (SAS) and non-volatile memory express (NVMe) drives. There is also a shift in the usage of configurations. "We can really expect to see SSDs dominate the desktop environments. The user may actually see a tiered approach between the hard drive, SAS SSDs and NVMe SSDs as appropriate, although likely not all three in the same configuration," she said.

In the case of external storage, there is much of the same shift in a more accelerated manner, she noted. Recent trends indicate a strong demand for all flash arrays, as they continue to deliver higher performance configuration, with users moving towards NVMe SSD based arrays.

A survey on 'Types of SSDs organisations use in all-flash arrays' reveals a 22 per cent increase in the usage of SAS SSDs and a greater increase of 26 per cent in the use of NVMe over the last two years..

Another emerging area is the persistent memory. Ahlver said, "Users may be planning a 12 to 20 per cent increased adoption of persistent memories over the next couple of years. Each one of these trends in the storage industry has a huge impact on how users are building their storage environments and data management."